Proxy vs Reverse Proxy

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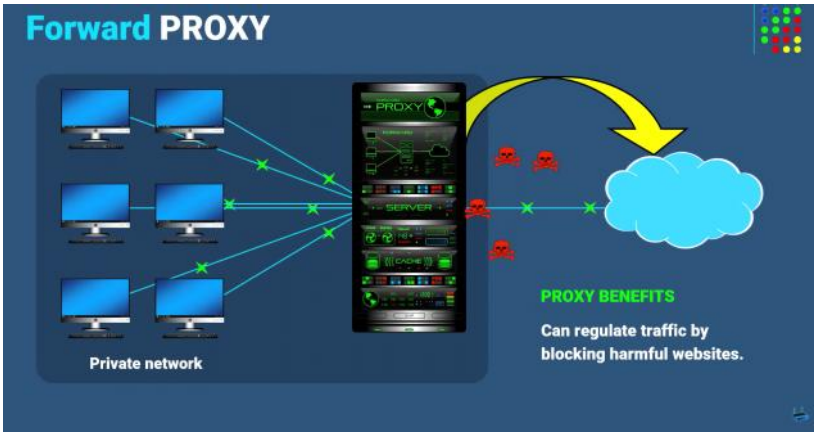
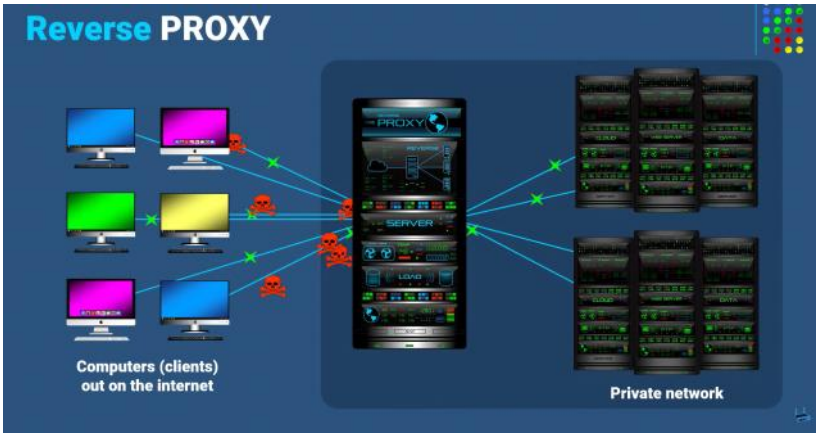
Proxy vs Reverse Proxy

A proxy server acts as a middleman between users and the internet. In a forward proxy, client devices send requests to the pr oxy, which then accesses the internet on their behalf. It improves security, hides client IP addresses, filters traffic, logs activity, and can cache data to improve speed.



A reverse proxy sits in front of servers instead of clients. It handles incoming requests from the internet and forwards them to the appropriate server. It protects servers by hiding their IP addresses, blocks malicious traffic like DDoS attacks, and can distribute traffic across multiple servers for better performance like load balancer.



In short, a forward proxy protects clients, while a reverse proxy protects servers.